

CLASH OF THE **CLAWS**

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**NightOwl: the off-hours engineer
that ships PRs while you're away
from the keyboard**

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Problem Statement

Why this theme (Productivity)

- Productivity tools got better at coding at the laptop. They don't help you when you're off your table.

What problem are you solving

- Developers can't delegate engineering work to an AI while they're away from the keyboard, even when the AI is fully capable of doing it.

Who Faces it (persona)

- **Me**, and Solo devs and indie hackers juggling a day job + 2-3 side projects. Anyone who has thought "I should ship X before Monday" on a Sunday evening with no realistic way to dispatch it.

Why is it important

- Velocity for individuals is bounded not by what AI can write, but by where the AI can run. Hours spent commuting, in meetings, or asleep are dead time today - that's a real chunk of the week.

The real gap in short

- while github copilot and some others can do cloud coding, you cannot personalize them beyond an extent with different skills for different projects and so on, **We propose "your personal intern" which grows and adapts to your coding workflow and preferences over time.**

Current Solution & Gaps

Existing solutions(if any)

- Github Copilot, Google Jules, etc

What's missing/broken

No tool spans both messaging and a kanban board as peer inputs.

- No per-repo personalization — Copilot/Jules Cloud agents are same behavior, every project. No place to teach the tool this repo's install command, test gate, or coding norms.
- No memory across sessions — each invocation starts cold. Your "intern" forgets you between Mondays.
- Voice is absent — every tool assumes you're typing, while Voice is arguably much faster and convenient for times while you're commuting or don't have your pc around.
- No clear read-write boundaries.

Opportunity

Build a personal AI agent that you can make your own intern, give it access to tools, teach it workflows and styles as you spend more time with it, it can grow in capability alongside you and help you work while you're on and off the workbench.

NightOwl is ~700 lines of Python and markdown over OpenClaw, not a fork of an IDE.

Your Solutions

What you built

- NightOwl — an OpenClaw-native autonomous developer agent with two ways to delegate, one shared brain.
 1. Telegram (text + voice) — for delegating on the go.
 2. Linear / GitHub Issues board watcher — for delegating during work hours.

Both feed the same skill library and ship from the same dedicated GitHub bot identity (a github account for the agent)

Core Ideas Explanation

Separate where the work comes from (the channel) from what the work is (the skill).

Then make both personalizable per project — your repo's WORKFLOW.md tells NightOwl how to install, test, build, and deploy this specific codebase. Your agent's MEMORY.md remembers what it learned across sessions.

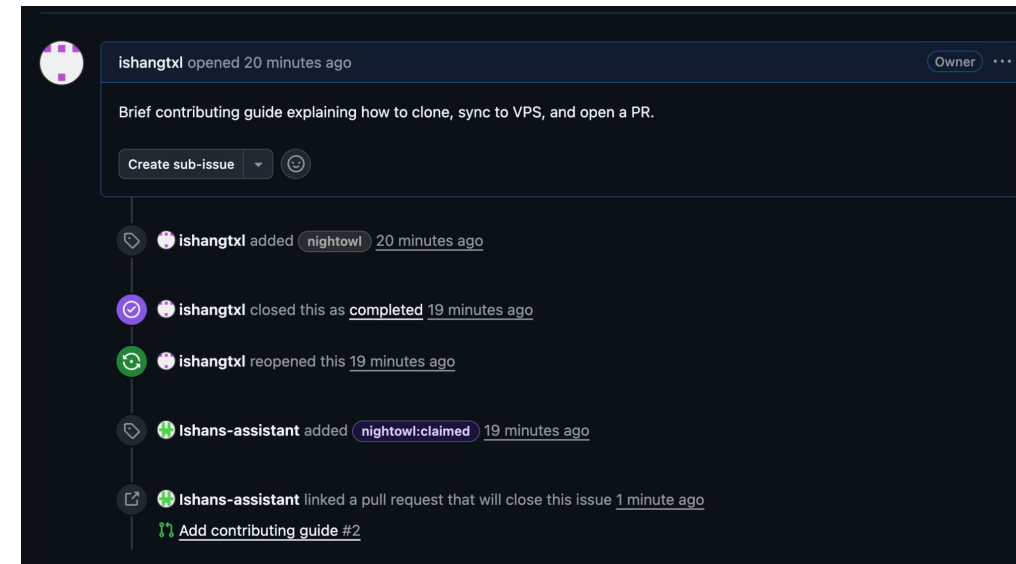
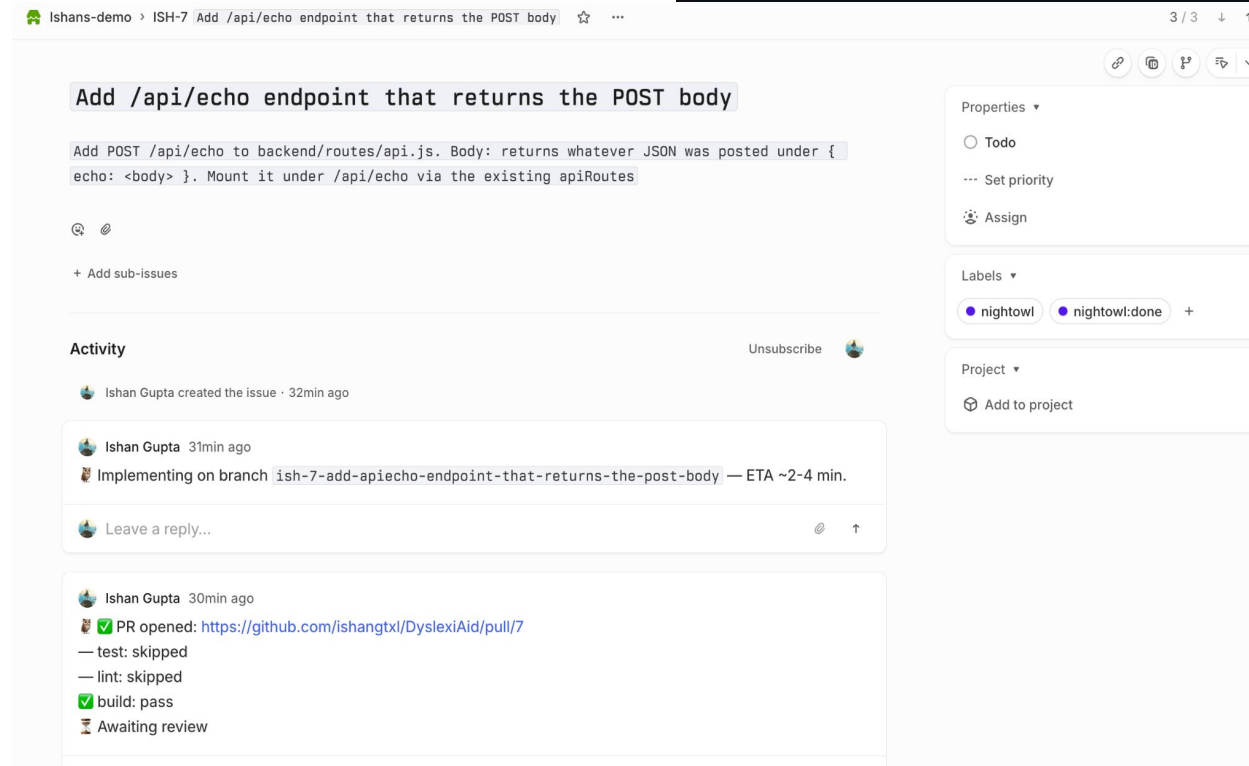
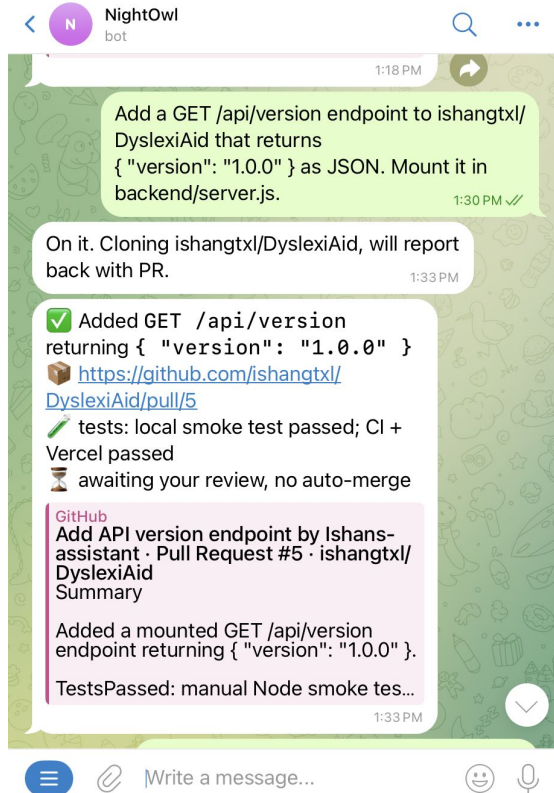
Key Features

- **Telegram** → **PR** — text or voice note, finished PR back in DM.
- **Ticket** → **PR** — drag a Linear ticket, claimed in 30s, PR in ~3 min.
- **WORKFLOW.md per repo** — install / test / lint / build / deploy commands and the prompt template live with the code, version-controlled.
- **Pluggable skills** — feature-flow, PR review, security audit shipped today; deploy and monitor on the roadmap.
- **Persistent memory** — MEMORY.md per agent, daily journals, OpenClaw exec-approvals for risky ops.
- **Bounded concurrency** — multiple parallel tickets honour a global cap (default 2).
- **Read-mostly** — never merges, force-pushes, or deploys to prod without explicit human approval.

Demo/Product Walkthrough

3 Ways to interact:

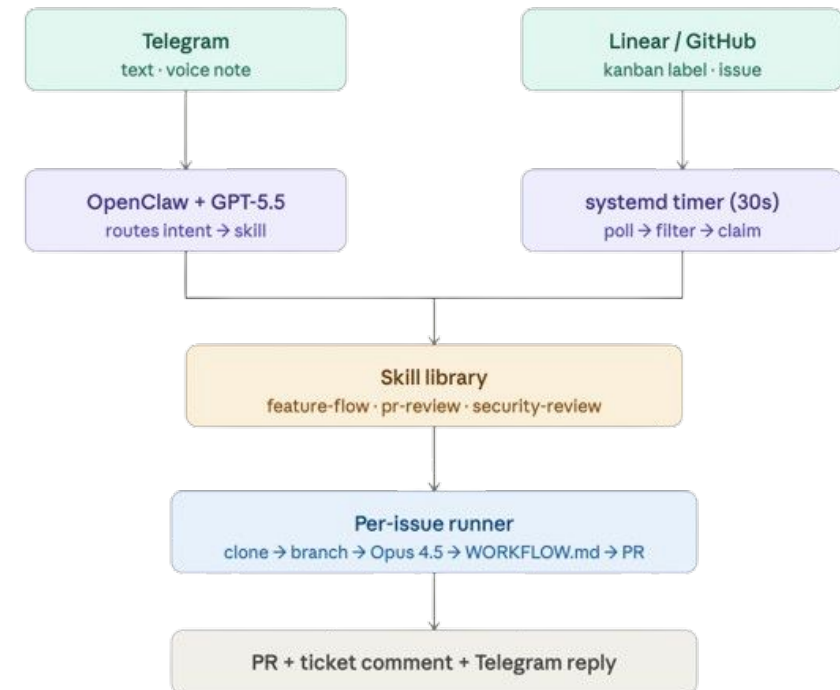
1. Telegram app - mobile or desktop - text or voice message
2. Linear project management application - web or mobile app
3. Github Issues and comments



Tech & Architecture

Layer	Tech
Agent platform	OpenClaw 2026.5 — channels, agents, skills, memory
Messaging	Telegram (OpenClaw plugin) + Whisper (voice → text)
Trackers	Linear (GraphQL) + GitHub Issues — pluggable BoardAdapter
Polling	Python + systemd timer (30s tick)
Repo ops	gh CLI + git — authenticated as @Ishans-assistant
Hosting	Hostinger VPS (Linux)

Model	Role
GPT-5.5 (MS Foundry)	Telegram orchestrator — routes intent, picks skill, phrases reply
Claude Opus 4.5 (Anthropic)	Per-issue runner — writes the actual code via Claude Code CLI



Impact & Use cases

Example use Cases:

Commute to PR — Dictate *"Add a GET /api/version endpoint"* from your cab; NightOwl branches, codes, and opens a passing PR before you reach the office. No laptop touched.

Sleep-time sprint — Drag four backlog tickets into Linear on Sunday night; wake up Monday to four green-CI PRs, auto-linked and ready to review — not write.

Mid-meeting review — Send *"Review PR #57"* on Telegram; NightOwl posts line comments, security flags, and a verdict on GitHub — then pings you back with the summary. Two minutes, zero context-switching.

Scale Potential:

Per-user	Per-team	Compounding
5–10 hrs/week reclaimed	New teammate: 5 min setup	WORKFLOW.md grows per repo
\$0.05–0.20 per PR	New repo: 1 file	MEMORY.md grows per session
4 PRs overnight, hands-free	New tracker: ~200 lines	Day 1 = contractor → Month 6 = intern who knows your codebase

One developer · one VPS · one bot identity = ~10× delegation surface for hours you weren't going to use.

Differentiation

	Cursor / Copilot	Codex / Claude	Symphony	NightOwl
Works while away from laptop	✓	✓	✓	✓
Messaging through app (text + voice)	✗	✓	✗	✓
Kanban input	✗	✗	Linear only	✓ Linear + GitHub
Per-repo personalization	✗	✗	partial	✓
Persistent memory across sessions	✗	✗	✗	✓
Pluggable skills (review, deploy...)	✗	✗	✗	✓
Built on a generalizable platform	✗	✗	✗	✓ OpenClaw

Moat 1 — Compounding personalization Every WORKFLOW.md, MEMORY.md entry, and custom skill becomes a per-user knowledge asset that doesn't transfer to a competitor.

Day 1 NightOwl is a contractor. Month 6 NightOwl is an intern who knows your codebase. Switching means starting over.

Moat 2 — Platform-native composability

NightOwl is ~700 lines on top of OpenClaw. Every new OpenClaw channel or skill is a free NightOwl feature.

New tracker support is one Python file.

Competitors would have to build or fork an entire agent platform to match this - and lose the ecosystem benefits either way.

Personalization keeps users in. Platform composability makes new features cheap. One protects the back door. The other widens the front door.

Demo Link

GitHub Repo: <https://github.com/ishangtxl/NightOwl>

Demo Link : https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1USl1UKlcpfyrZLTm7_T97nZnjTFuVPWP?usp=sharing

Document submitted (original draft over which improvements were made):

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/12BWfdBBHBvHLgL14TaBfwRi3eedOpST1/view?usp=sharing>

Why we built this

We built NightOwl mostly for ourselves.

We didn't make the most of our first two years of college. The past few months we've been trying to catch up, applying for everything we can find, registering for what's open, while running an internship at one company and a part-time remote full-stack job at another. Most weeks there's more we want to ship than there are hours to ship it.

We've wanted a tool, for a while, that could code small things, fix bugs, or review a PR for us while we're on our way home or asleep. Something to take a few hours off the pile, so we wouldn't be the bottleneck on every backlog item. Nothing existed that fit, until OpenAI open-sourced Symphony. That gave us the shape of the kanban half of the idea, and we built the rest around it.

NightOwl is the version that matches our actual lives. Two input channels, both async, both honest about safety. Over the next few months we plan to keep evolving it until it's a real part of our day-to-day, not just a hackathon submission.

Thank you.